

Week 3 Tutorial

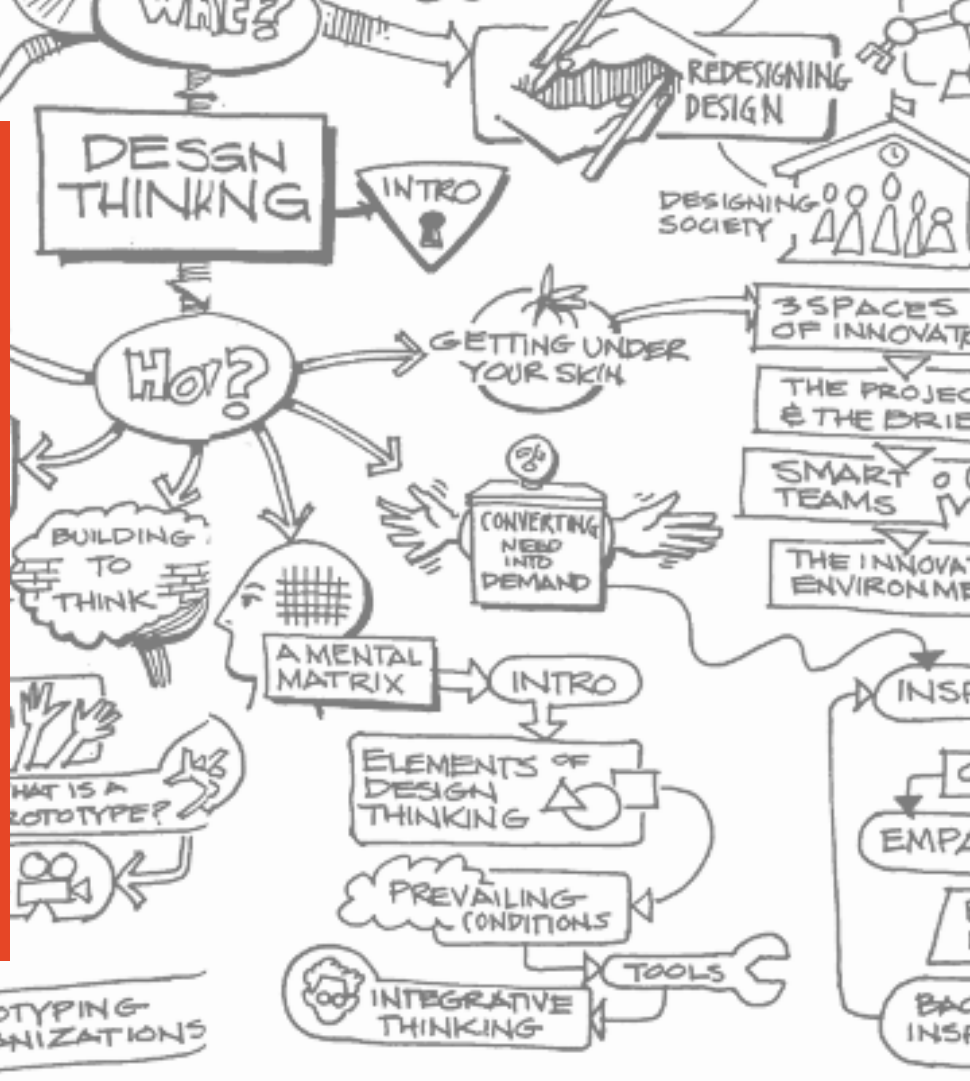
Primary Research planning: Interviews

IDEA9106 Design Thinking
Semester 2 2026



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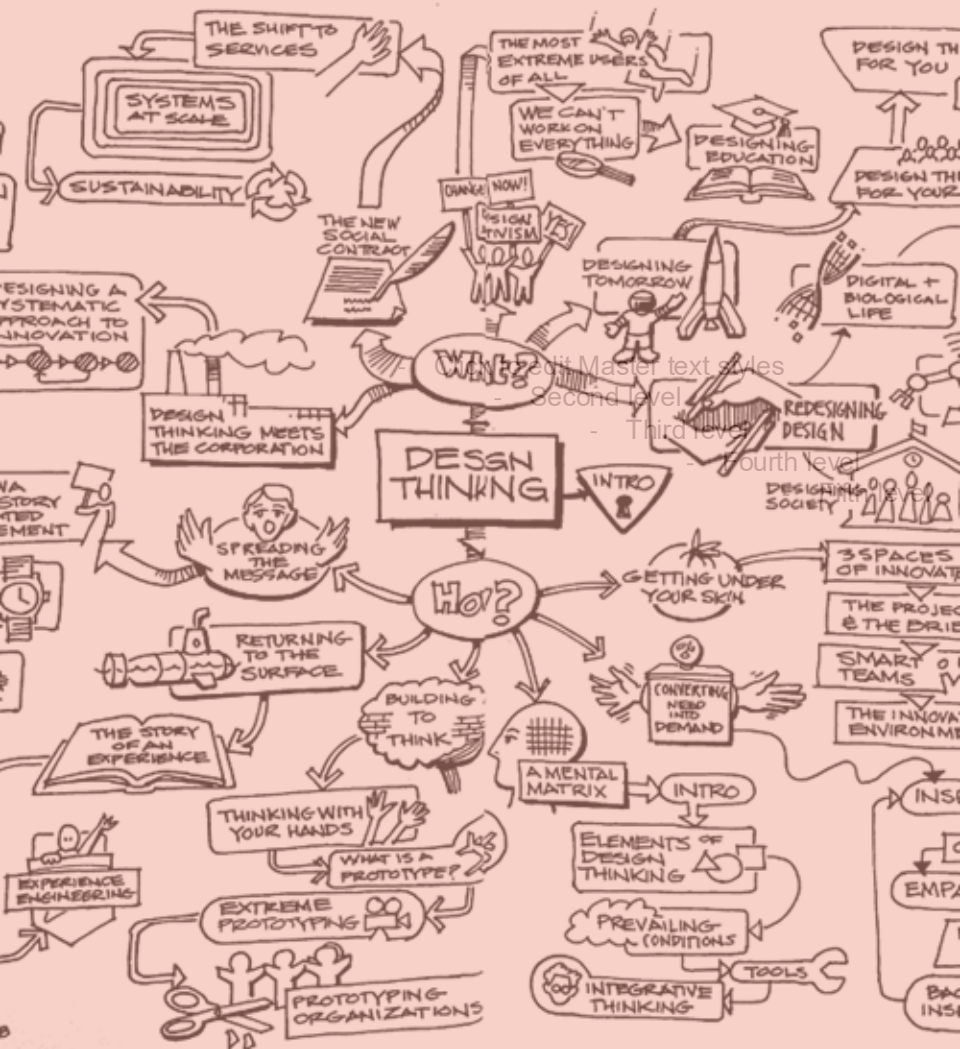
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We recognise and pay respect to the Elders and communities - past and present - of the lands upon which this University of Sydney campus sits. Indigenous knowledge has been generated and shared for thousands of years, underpinned by a strong connection to land, sea and culture.

We seek to continue to exchange knowledge and build connections upon these traditions.



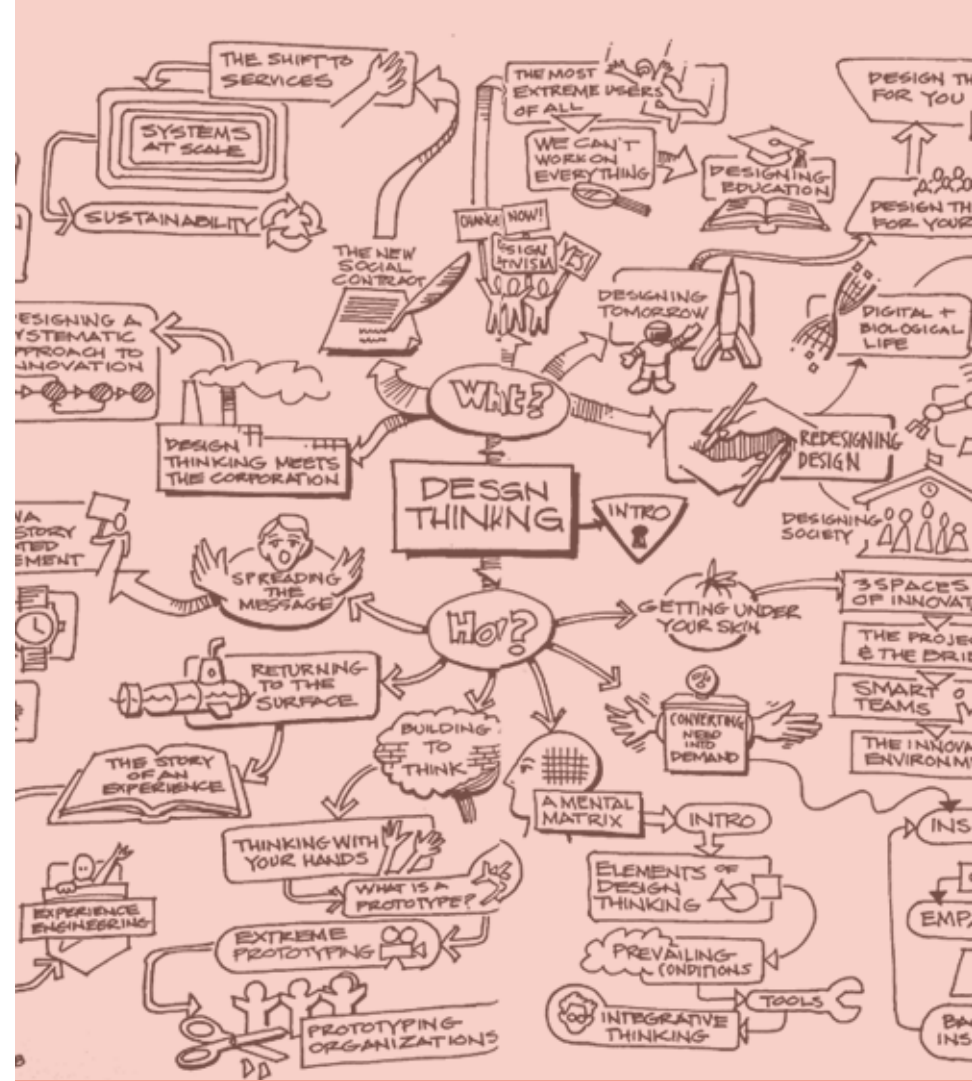


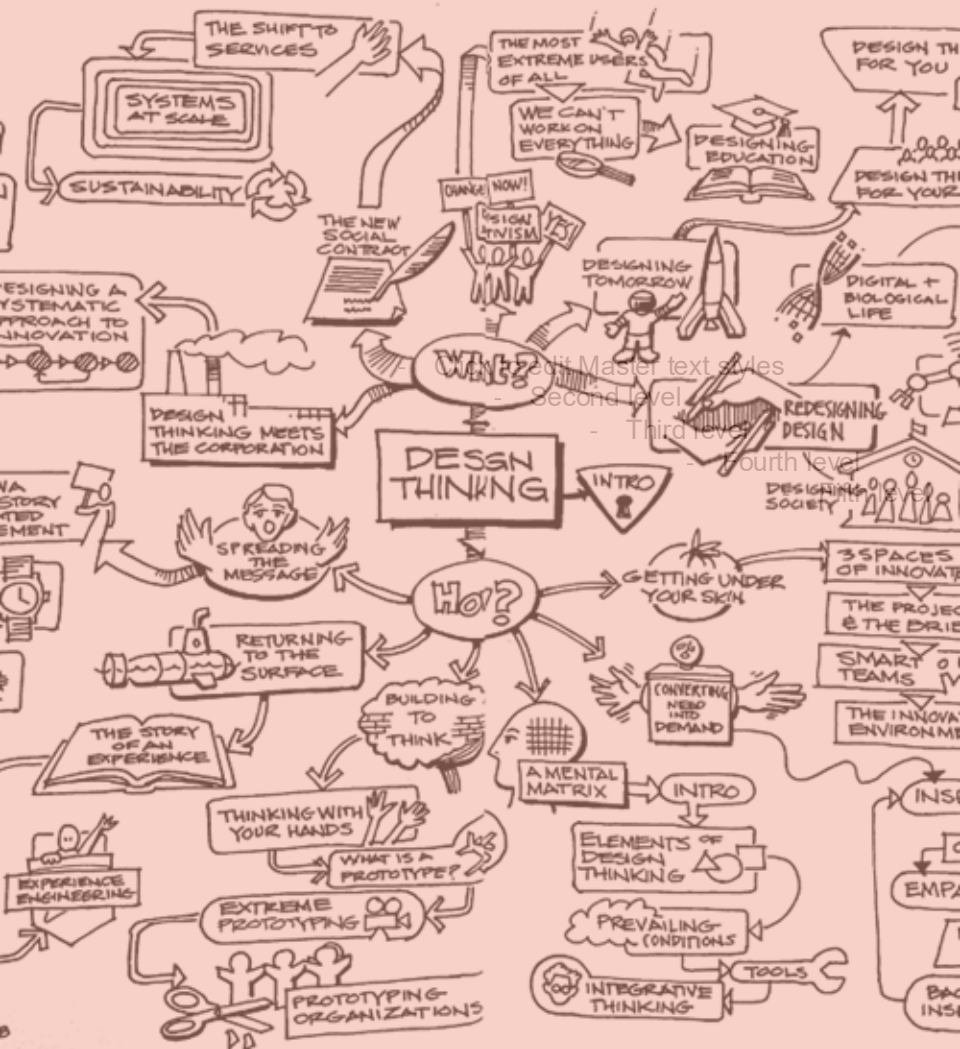
Tutorial aims

In this tutorial students will:

- finalise project groups and begin drafting A2a. Team agreement
- practice contextual observation and guerrilla interviews using role play
- begin drafting an individual research plan

- Finalise groups
- Role play: Contextual observation & Guerrilla interviews
- Individual research plan
- Before next week
- Wrap Up



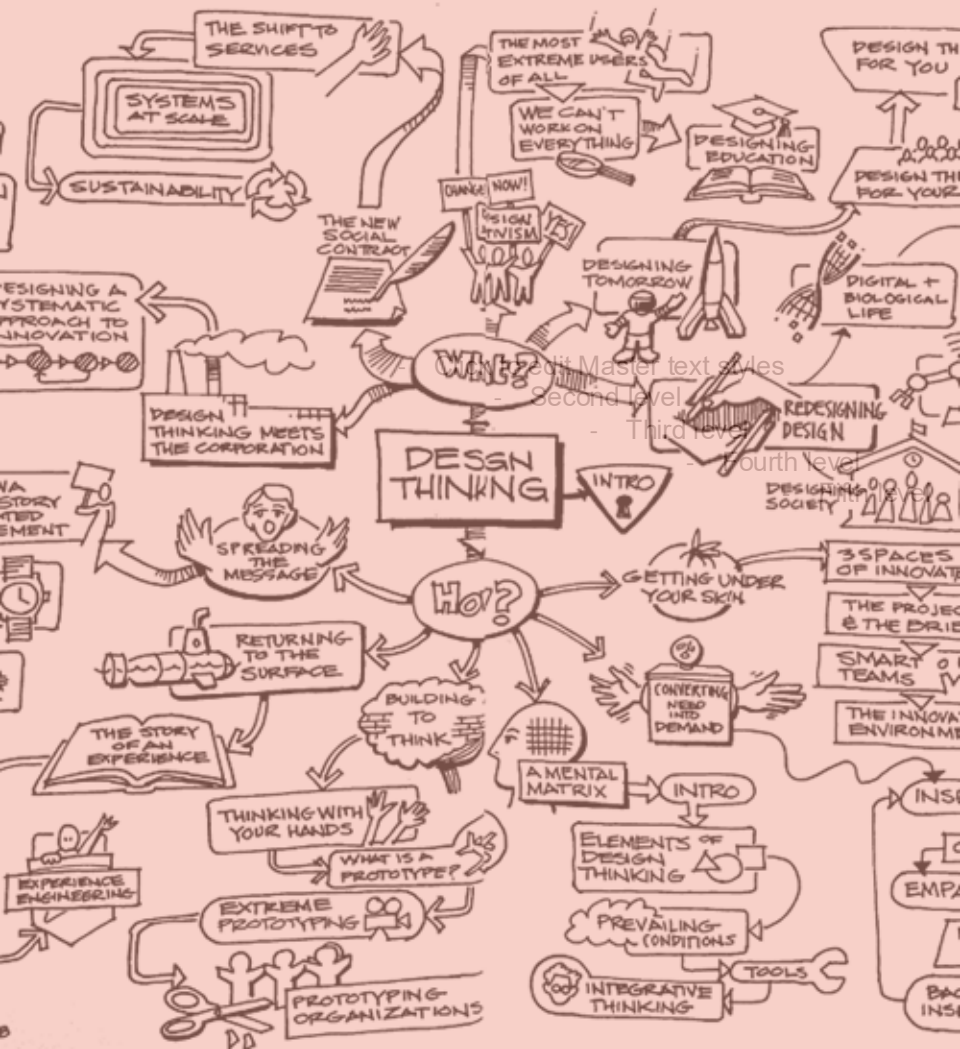


Finalise groups

Project groups of five students (from the same tutorial)

Register project groups on Canvas > People

Download A2a. Team agreement from Canvas and complete with your project group members



Role play

Contextual observation and guerrilla interviews are two ways to conduct design research and collect qualitative, user research data

Role play: Observation & interviews

1. Contextual observation

- a) Watch the short videos on the Week 3 module.
- b) What is interesting, confusing or strange?
- c) Write two open-ended questions that respond to your observations and the brief.

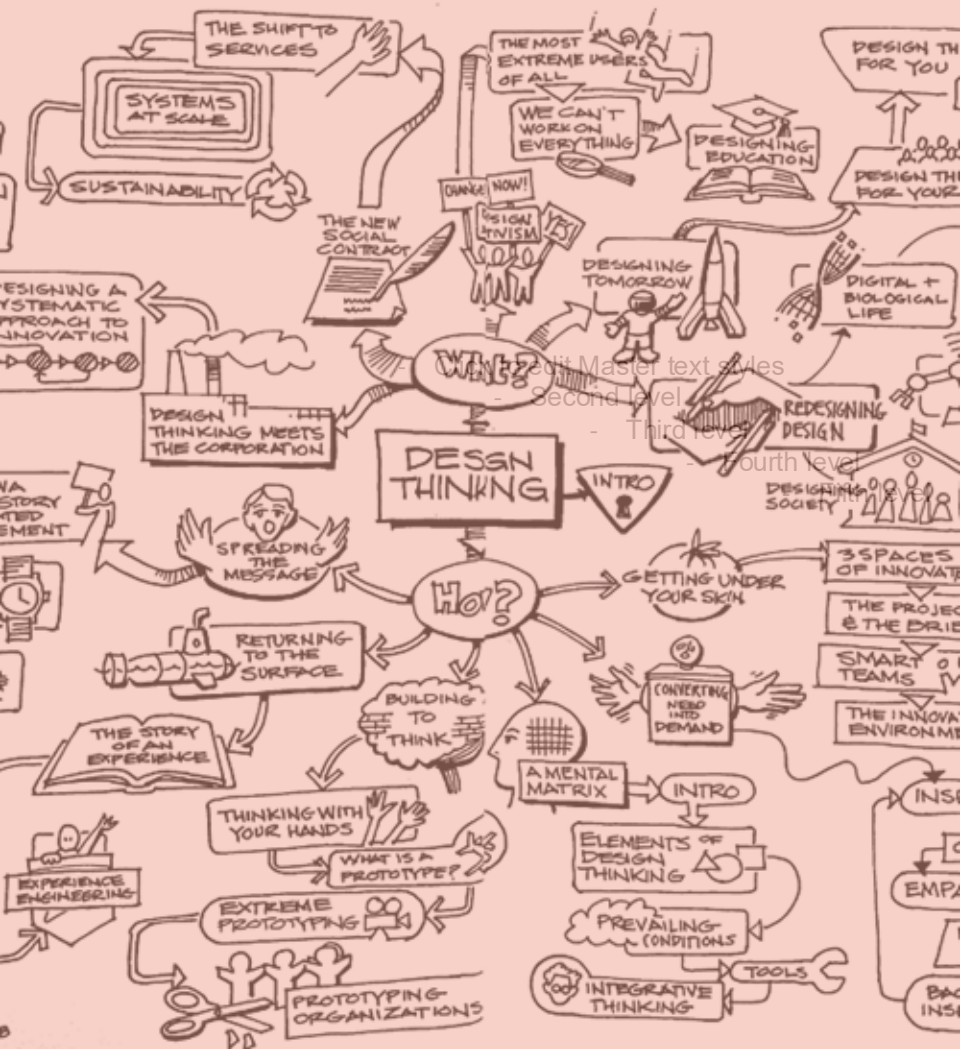
2. Brainstorming open-ended interview questions

3. Guerrilla interviews

- a) Role play a guerrilla (impromptu) interview using the open-ended questions from your contextual observation.
- b) One person will ask the questions and the other group members will role play assisting with recording and note taking.

Let's practice guerrilla interviews for A3.

1. Introduce yourselves
 2. Let the interviewee know you are conducting interviews for your course, IDEA9106
 3. Are they happy to answer a few questions and be recorded?
 4. Don't forget to sign the consent form (simulate in roleplay)
 5. Ask the interview questions
 6. Ask related, probing questions
 7. Thank participants for their time
- If you have time, conduct another interview and swap roles among the group members.
 - Complete the post-interview reflection on Figma as part of your preparation for the individual interviews for A3.

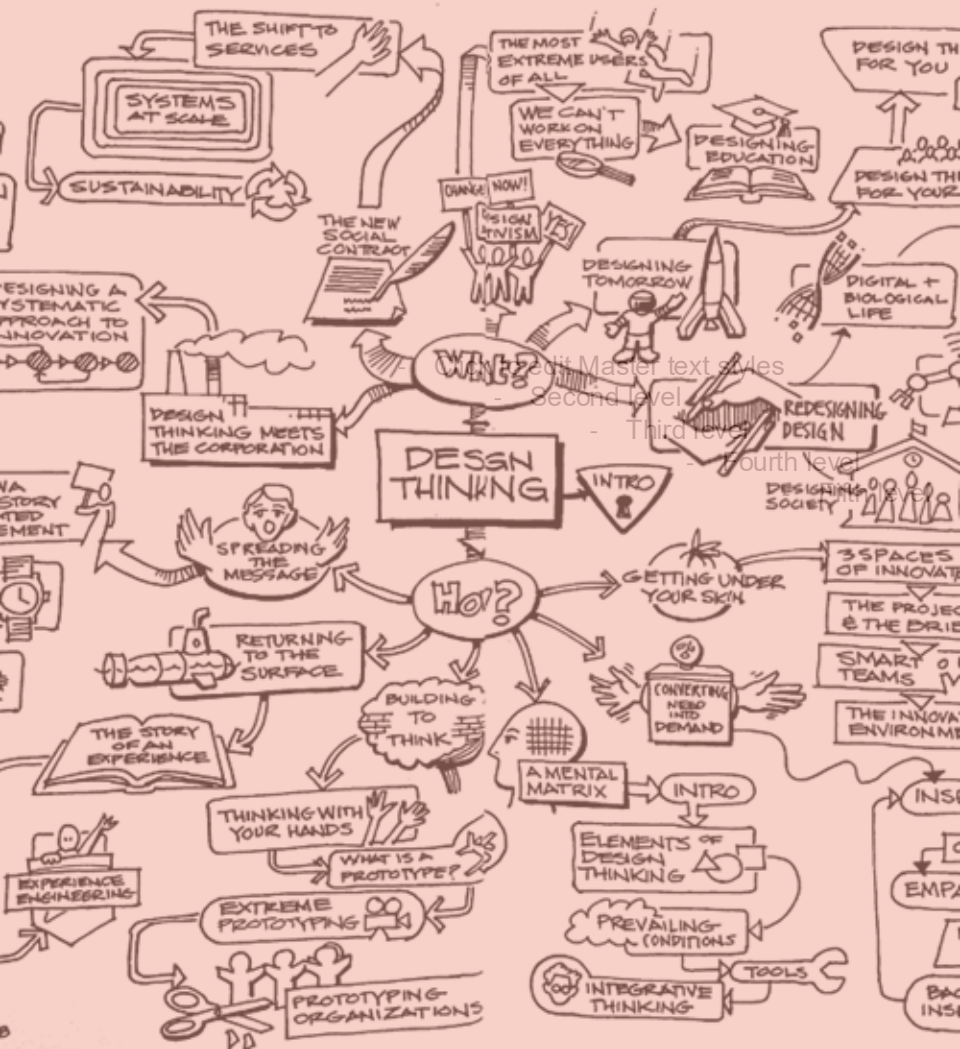


Research Plan

Download the template on Canvas/Week 3 module.

Working **individually**, based on your secondary research to-date and the design brief, complete the first two sections of the plan (15 mins)

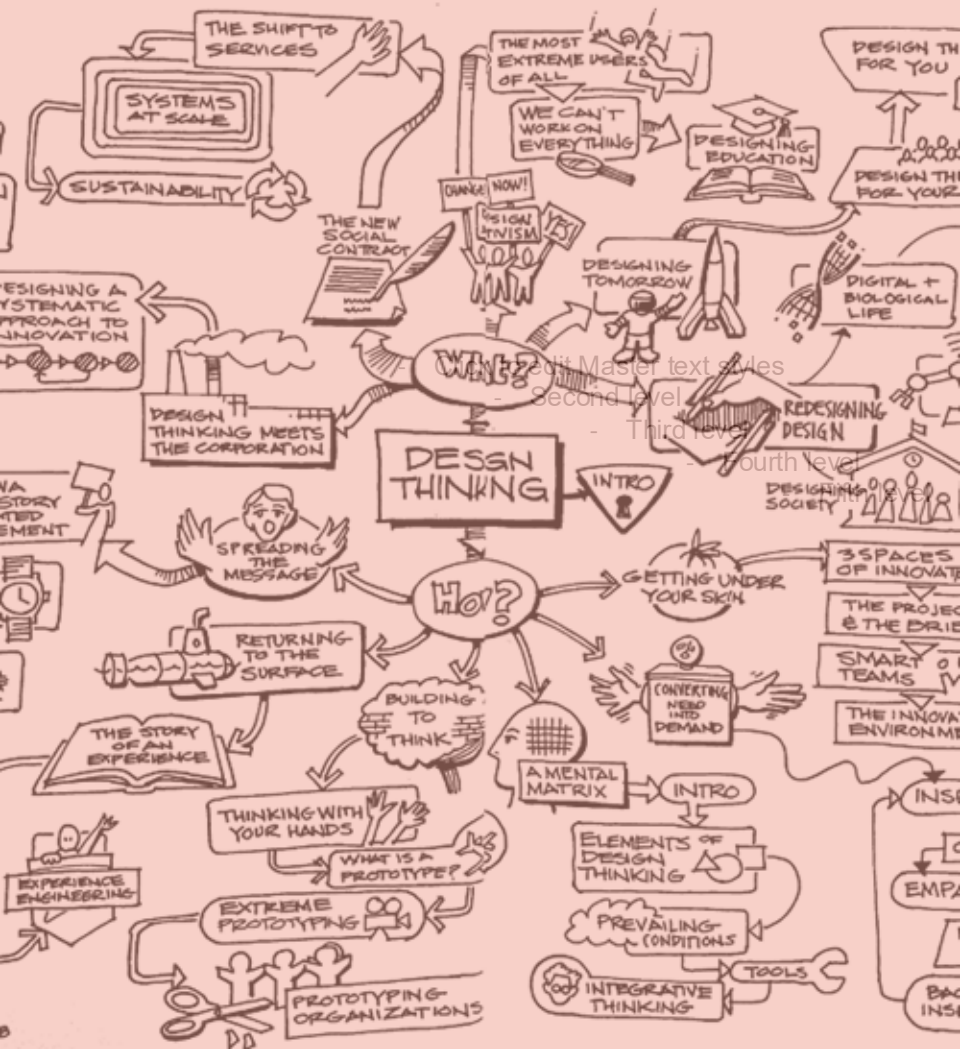
- Project area
- Target users



Research Plan

Now work on the next two sections (15 mins)

- Recruitment process
- Ethical considerations

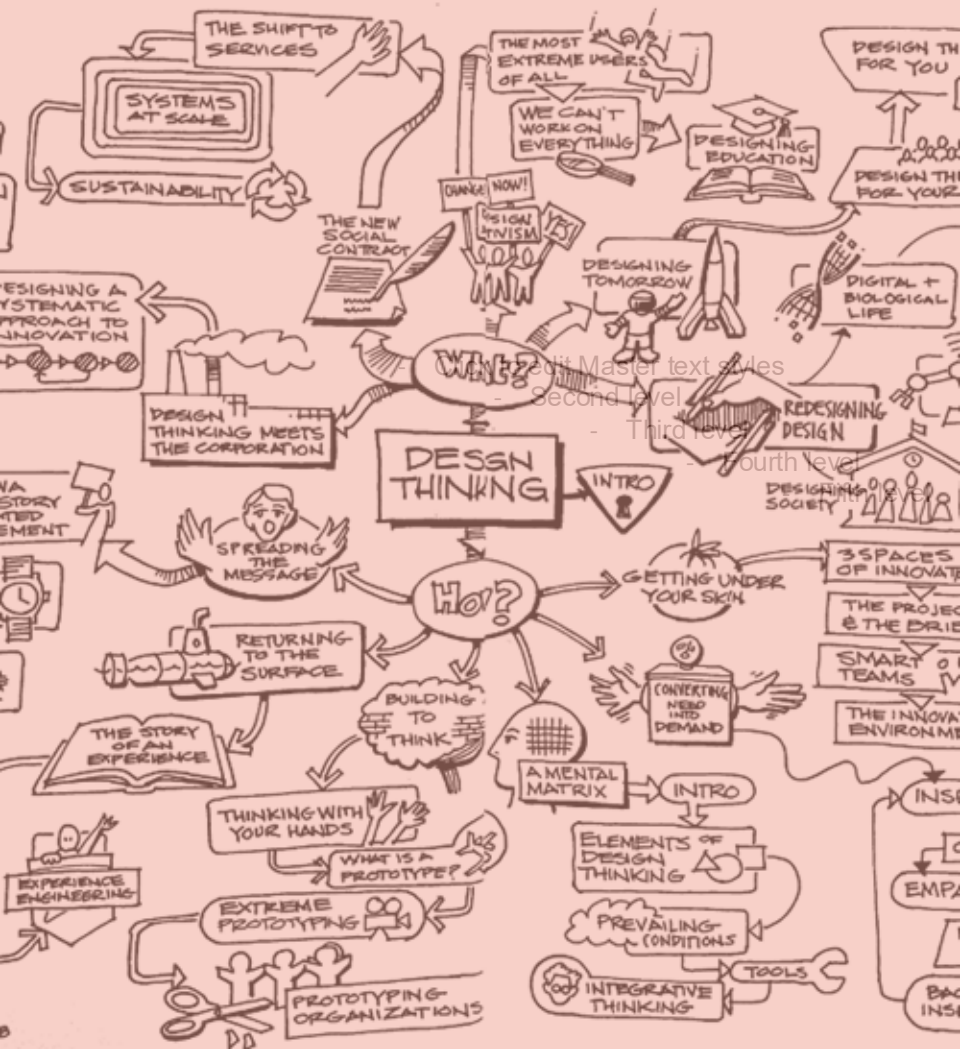


Research Plan

Now work on the last two sections (10 mins)

- Interview questions (you can copy questions from the observation activity if they're appropriate)
- Risks (matrix on Figma)

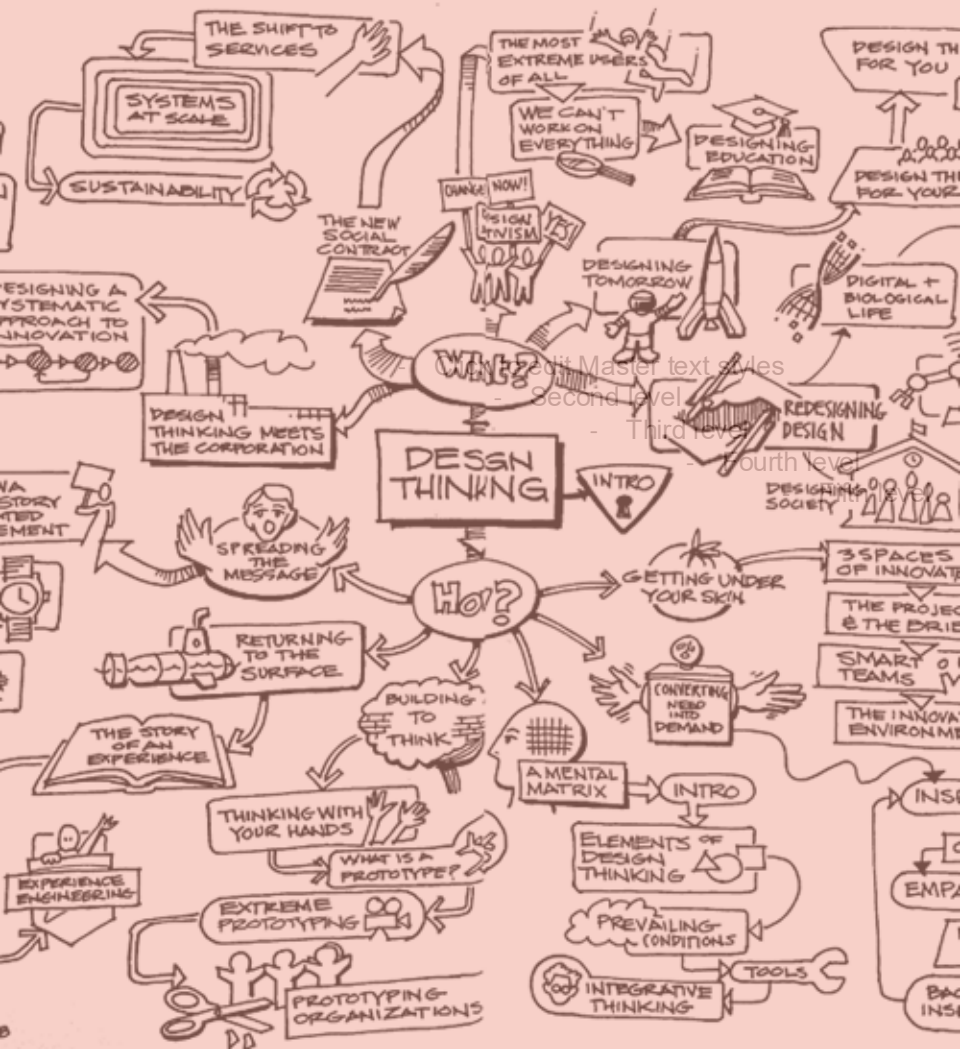
Hot tip: Conduct a contextual observation & guerrilla interview this week as a pilot, to improve your research plan for A3.



Interview questions

Do ...

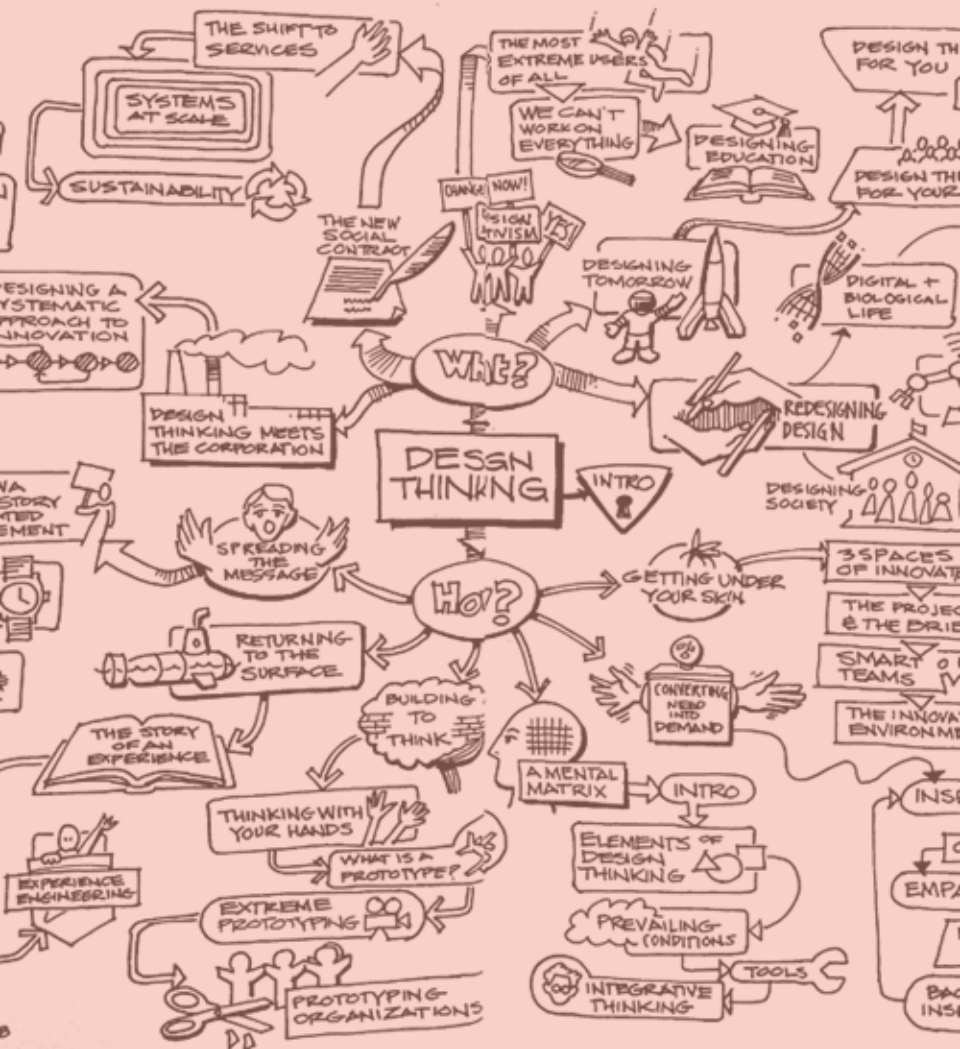
- ask open-ended questions, starting with 'How', 'Why', 'What', 'When' or 'Where'
- ask for concrete examples, such as "tell me about the last time you ..."
- ask participants if they have problems understanding the question



Interview questions

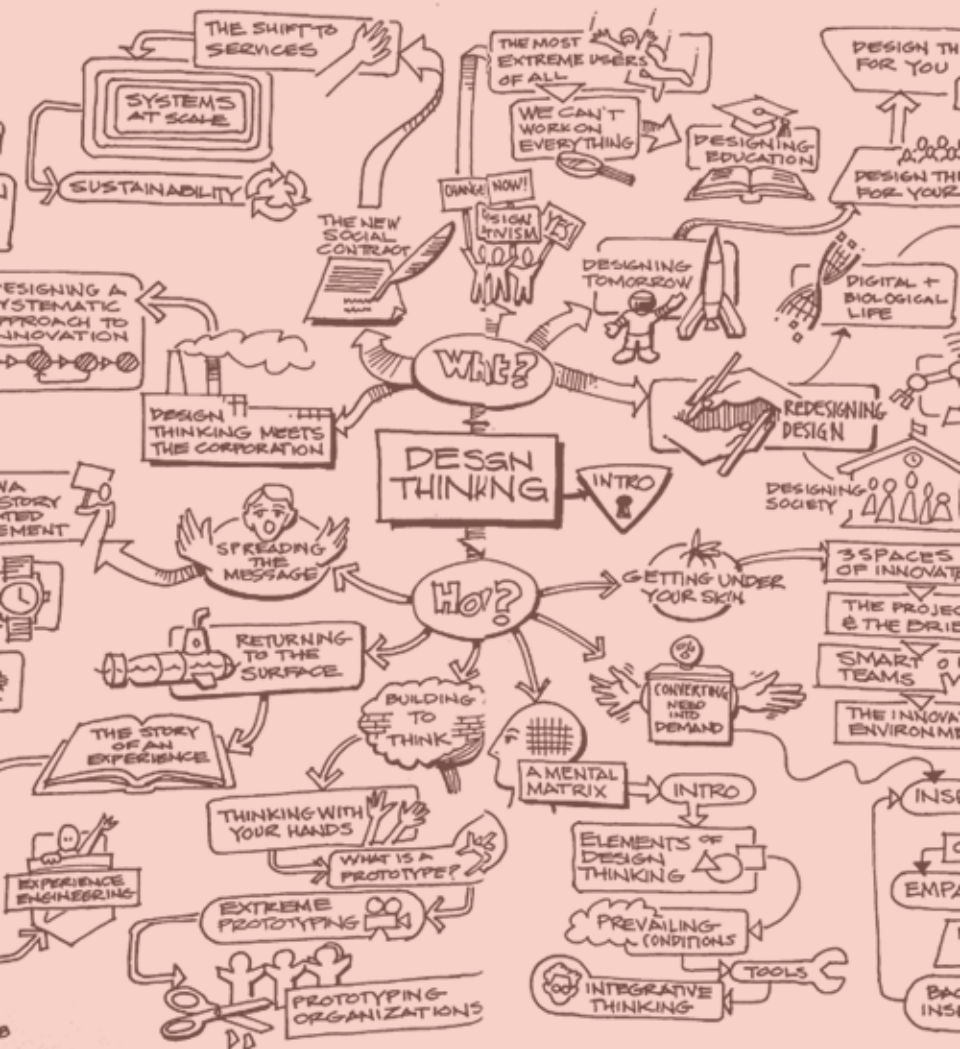
Don't ...

- ask leading questions
- ask speculative questions like “what would you do...”
- ask vague questions so participants need to guess what you mean
- ask questions where participants don't know the context



Before next week

- Submit A2a. Team Agreement before deadline!
- Finalise your research plan
- Conduct a contextual observation and guerrilla interview as a pilot for A3.
- Read through the Week 4 canvas module & complete the pre-work



Wrap Up

- Any questions regarding A2a. Team agreement or A3. Context exploration and mapping?
- Any unexpected insights from this tutorial?
- Is there anything that's still not clear or is confusing?

SEE YOU NEXT WEEK!



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